



Rush of youth: Barcelona has been stellar in La Liga, with 17-year-old Lamine Yamal (left) being the focal point of its success. AP

brushed off the disappointment of its North London derby against Arsenal, winning 3-1 against Brentford.

Dominic Solanke scored his first goal for the club after his summer move, with Brennan Johnson and James Maddison scoring the other two.

Aston Villa continued to shine under Unai Emery. After a 3-2 win against Everton, the Claretts followed it up with a 3-1 win against Wolverhampton Wanderers.

After matchday five, defending champion City tops the table with 13 points, followed by Liverpool, Aston Villa, and Arsenal. Chelsea is fifth, while Manchester United languishes in 11th.

La Liga

Barcelona and new manager Hansi Flick might have faced ridicule after its loss against Monaco in its Champions League 2024-25 opener. However, the Blaugranas have been stellar in La Liga, with 17-year-old Lamine Yamal being the focal point of its success. After scoring a brace in Barcelona's 4-1 win against Girona, Yamal bagged an assist in its 5-1 thumping of Villarreal, where Robert Lewandowski and Raphinha each grabbed a brace, and Pablo Torres also found the net.

Defending champion Real Madrid

made easy work of newly-promoted Espanyol, thumping it 4-1. Dani Carvajal, Rodrygo, and Vinicius Junior scored the first three goals for Los Blancos from open play. Kylian Mbappe added the last from the penalty spot, as the Frenchman continues to settle into life at the Santiago Bernabeu. Goalkeeper Thibaut Courtois would have bagged a clean sheet if not for an error that saw the Belgian concede an own goal in the 54th minute.

After a brilliant win against RB Leipzig in its Champions League opener, the mood was positive in the

« The Milan derby was the biggest talking point in Italian football ahead of the last matchday »